

KARACTER NEWS

Your Website Handbook

How to publish stories, podcasts and more

Welcome

This short guide shows you how to run your news website, karaktermedia.com. Everything happens in one place called the **dashboard**. Think of it as the newsroom behind your website: you write and manage everything there, and the website updates itself instantly.

1. Logging in

1. In your browser, go to **karaktermedia.com/admin**
2. Enter your email address and password.
3. You will land on the dashboard. The left-hand menu lists everything you can manage: Articles, Media, Categories, Podcast Shows, Podcast Episodes, and more.

Tip: bookmark the admin page on your phone and computer so it is always one tap away.

2. Publishing a story

1. In the left menu, click **Articles**, then the **Create New** button.
2. **Title** — the headline readers will see.
3. **Excerpt** — one or two sentences that tease the story. This appears on the homepage and on Google.
4. **Cover Image** — click Create New to upload a photo from your computer. Always fill in the short “Alt” description (say what is in the picture — it helps blind readers and Google).
5. **Content** — write the story itself. It works like a simple Word document: highlight text to make it bold, add headings, links and pictures.
6. On the right-hand side, choose a **Category** (e.g. Politics, Business) and any **Tags**.
7. Still on the right, set **Status** to **Published** and click **Save**. The story is now live on the website.

Do not worry about the field called **Slug** — it creates itself from the title and becomes the story’s web address.

Saving a draft instead

Not ready to publish? Set Status to **Draft** and Save. Only your team can see drafts. When the story is ready, change the status to Published.

Publishing at a future time

Want a story to go out at 6 a.m. tomorrow by itself? Set Status to **Scheduled**, pick the date and time in **Published At**, and Save. The website publishes it automatically at that moment — you can sleep.

The five statuses in plain words

- **Draft** — still being written. Invisible to readers.
- **In Review** — a writer has finished and asks an editor to check it.
- **Scheduled** — will publish itself at the chosen time.
- **Published** — live on the website for everyone.
- **Archived** — taken off the site but kept safely, not deleted.

3. Breaking news

When a big story breaks, open the article and tick the **Breaking news** box, then Save. A red scrolling banner with the headline instantly appears at the top of every page of the website. When the moment has passed, untick the box and the banner disappears.

4. Trending stories

The Trending section on the homepage takes care of itself. The website counts how many people read each story and automatically shows the five most-read stories of the last seven days. There is nothing for you to do.

5. Podcasts

First time only: create your show

1. Click **Podcast Shows** → **Create New**.
2. Give it a title, a short description, and a square cover picture (podcast apps want at least 1400×1400 pixels).
3. Save. You only do this once per show.

Every episode

1. Click **Podcast Episodes** → **Create New**.
2. Add the episode title and pick which show it belongs to.
3. Upload the audio file (MP3). The length is measured automatically.
4. Write the show notes — what the episode is about.
5. **Published At** — set the date and time; the episode becomes visible from that moment.
6. If the episode is also on YouTube, paste the video link in **YouTube URL** and the video player appears on the episode's page.

Your show also has an automatic **RSS feed** — the thing you submit once to Spotify or Apple Podcasts so new episodes appear there by themselves. Its address is karaktermedia.com/podcasts/your-show-name/rss.xml (you can copy the link from the show's page on the website).

6. Going live on YouTube

1. In the left menu, open **Site Settings** and find the **YouTube** section.
2. Paste your live stream link into **Live stream URL** and Save. A “Live now” video player appears at the top of the Podcasts page.
3. When the stream ends, delete the link from that box and Save. The player disappears.

The **Channel URL** box in the same place holds the permanent link to your YouTube channel, shown on the Podcasts page.

7. The newsletter

Every page of the website has a box where readers can leave their email address. Those addresses are collected automatically in your **Brevo** account (brevo.com). Log in there to see your subscribers and, when you are ready, send them newsletters.

8. Your team

You can give colleagues their own logins under **Users** → **Create New**. Each person gets a role that decides what they can do:

- **Admin** — full control of everything, including creating users. Keep this for one or two people.
- **Editor** — can write, edit and publish any story or podcast.

- **Author / Contributor** — can write their own stories and send them for review, but cannot publish. An editor presses the publish button. This protects the site from mistakes.

When creating a user, if the Slug field complains, click “Unlock” next to it and type the person’s name in lowercase with hyphens, like ada-obi.

9. Small dictionary

- **Slug** — the story’s web address, made from the headline (my-big-story). Creates itself.
- **Excerpt** — the teaser text under a headline.
- **Category** — the section a story belongs to (Politics, Sports...). One per story.
- **Tag** — extra labels for topics (elections, fuel-price...). As many as you like.
- **Alt text** — a short description of a picture, for blind readers and Google.
- **SEO** — the article’s appearance on Google. The SEO tab fills itself, but you can polish the title and description there.

10. If something looks wrong

- A story is missing from the site? Check its Status is **Published** — not Draft.
- Changed something but the page looks old? Refresh the page (pull down on your phone, or press Ctrl+R).
- Anything else — contact your developer. Nothing you do in the dashboard can break the website itself, so click around with confidence.